MEANING

The balance of power is one notion which is central to the study of international relations. The term is in no way an innovation of the present times and can be traced to the sixteenth century, only to be theorized in the eighteenth century and after. It appeared in treaties like the Treaty of Utrecht of 1713, in the memoirs of statesman, and in the writings of diplomats historians and lawyers. The diplomats of *Ancien Régime* (refers to the political system established in France from fourteenth century to eighteenth century under the Valois and Bourbon dynasties) considered it as the underlying principle that created stability. In the twentieth century it has been invoked many a times but the problem is that there is a lack of unanimity on the exact meaning of the term.[4] Inis L. Claude (1962) observed that "the trouble with the balance of power is not that it has no meaning but that it has too many meanings".

Professor A.F. Pollard (1923) stated that there are several thousand meanings of the phrase, but "The essential idea is simple enough: it is 'equilibrium' of the type represented by a pair of scales. When the weights in the scales are equal, balance results".

George Schwarzenberger (1951) viewed balance of power as 'an equilibrium' or "a certain amount of stability in international relations".

G. Lowes Dickinson(1926) clarified the two uses of the term 'balance'. He said that "it means, on the one hand, an equality, as of the two sides when an account is balanced, and on the other hand, an inequality, as when one has a 'balance' to one's credit at the bank". He also added "the balance of power theory professes the former, but pursues the latter".

According to Professor Sidney B. Fay (1937), balance of power is such a "just equilibrium in power among the members of the family of nations as will prevent any one of them from becoming sufficiently strong to enforce its will upon others".

Kaplan[5] in his *System and Process in International Politics,* distinguished between the balance of power system and other international systems. To him balance of power system is an international social system without a political subsystem. The actors